



THE UNIVERSITY OF
MELBOURNE

International Student Trends in 2025

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Context



On October 14, the Federal government announced its international student allocation for public universities.

It has allocated 295,000 international student places in 2026, of which **160,850 are for public (Table A) universities.**

The 160,850 places for public universities are **up 15,700 places (11%)** from 145,190 in 2025.

Largest increases went to **Federation University (64% increase** from 1,100 to 1,800) and **Charles Sturt University (60% increase** from 1,000 to 1,6000 places).

Key takeaways



University of Sydney was one of only 5 universities (and the only Go8 university) to receive **zero additional places**, potentially due to the fact they recorded 51% international students in 2024.

- Since 2016, University of Sydney has seen a **10% year-on-year annual growth in international students** while domestic student levels have shrunk -1%.

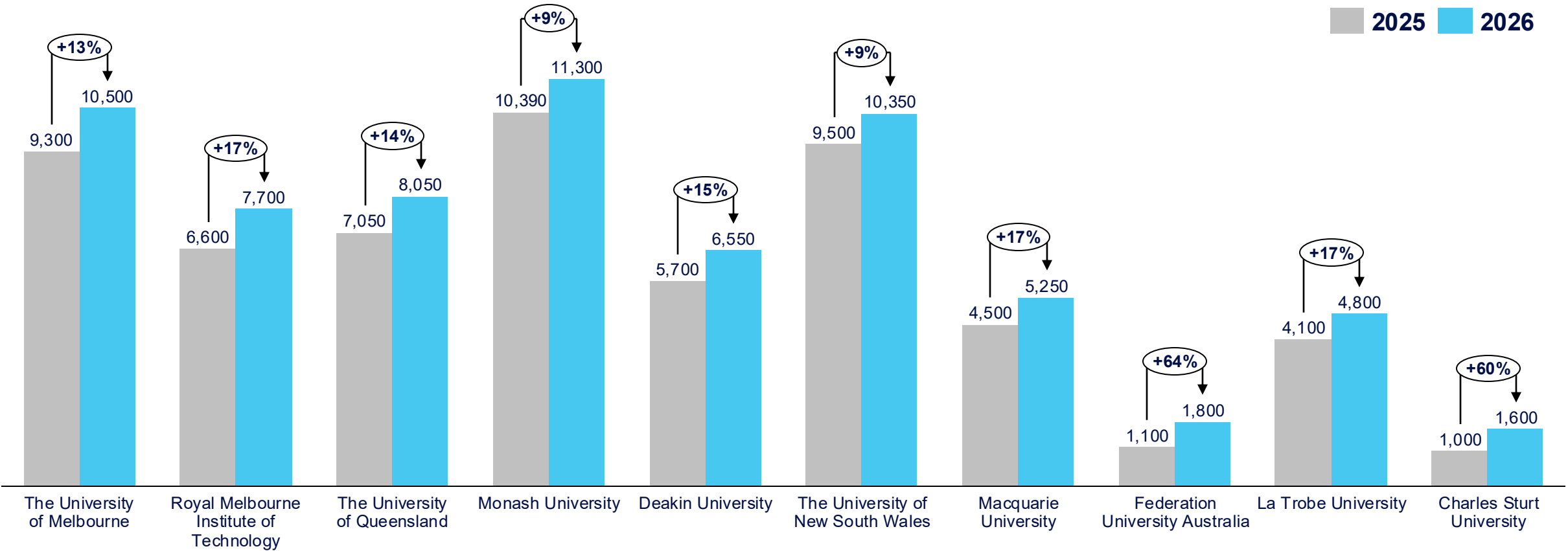
Other universities with the highest level of international student enrolments saw increases in their quotas:

- Murdoch University with **57% international students** received 400 additional places (**11% increase**)
- RMIT with **50% international students** received 1,100 additional places (**17% increase**)
- UNSW with **47% international students** received 850 additional places (**9% increase**)

Quota increases highest for Melbourne University, RMIT, and UQ



Top 10 quota increases (by # increase)



University of Sydney was denied additional international student places



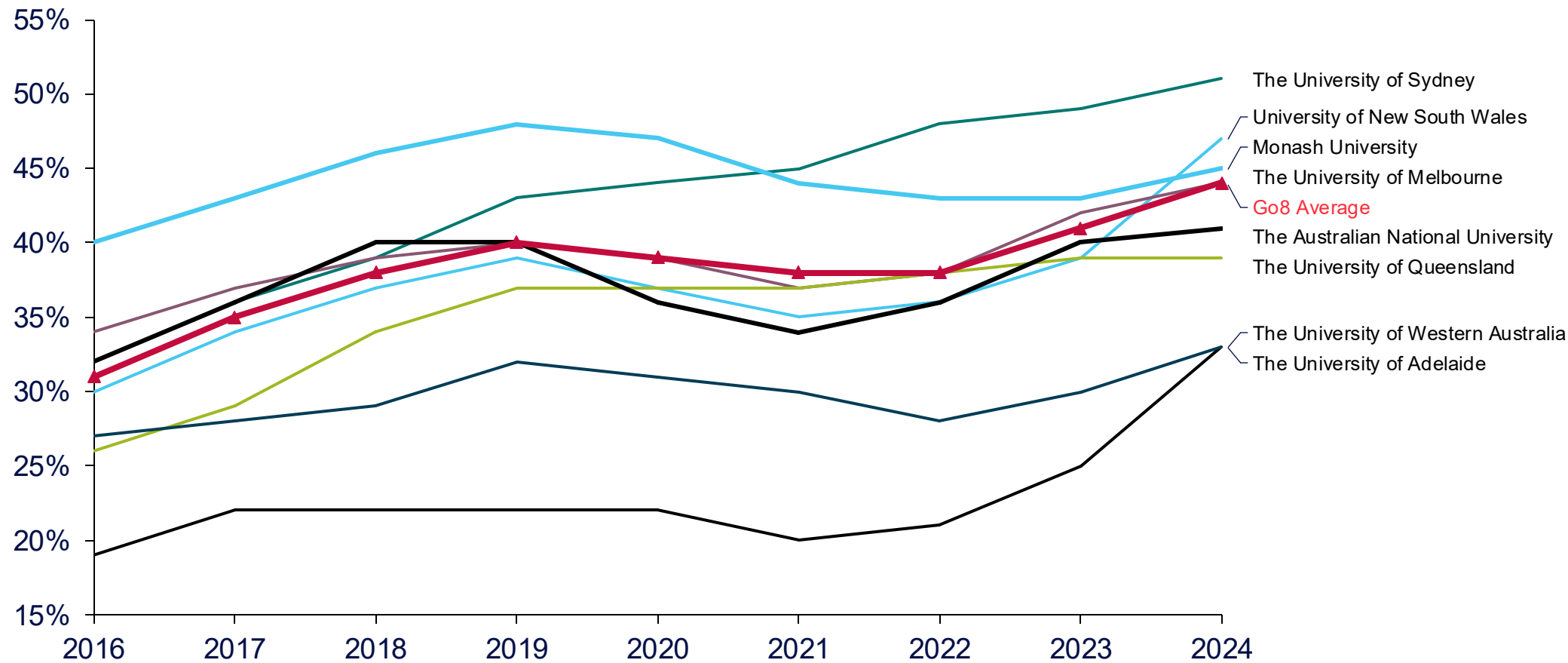
Top 10 international student universities

University	Percentage of international students	International students (2024)	Domestic students (2024)	2025 international student quota	2026 international student quota	Change from '25 to '26 (#)	Change from '25 to '26 (%)
Murdoch University	57%	14,157	10,624	3,500	3,900	400	11%
The University of Sydney	51%	40,111	38,771	11,900	11,900	0	0%
Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology	50%	37,998	37,911	6,600	7,700	1,100	17%
The University of New South Wales	47%	38,444	43,839	9,500	10,350	850	9%
University of Wollongong	46%	15,924	19,018	3,600	3,700	100	3%
Monash University	45%	42,270	50,957	10,390	11,300	910	9%
The University of Melbourne	44%	32,987	42,585	9,300	10,500	1,200	13%
Australian National University	41%	9,402	13,537	3,400	3,750	350	10%
James Cook University	39%	7,748	12,151	2,200	2,200	0	0%
The University of Queensland	39%	22,270	34,969	7,050	8,050	1,000	14%

Go8 international student rates have been increasing over time, currently at 44%



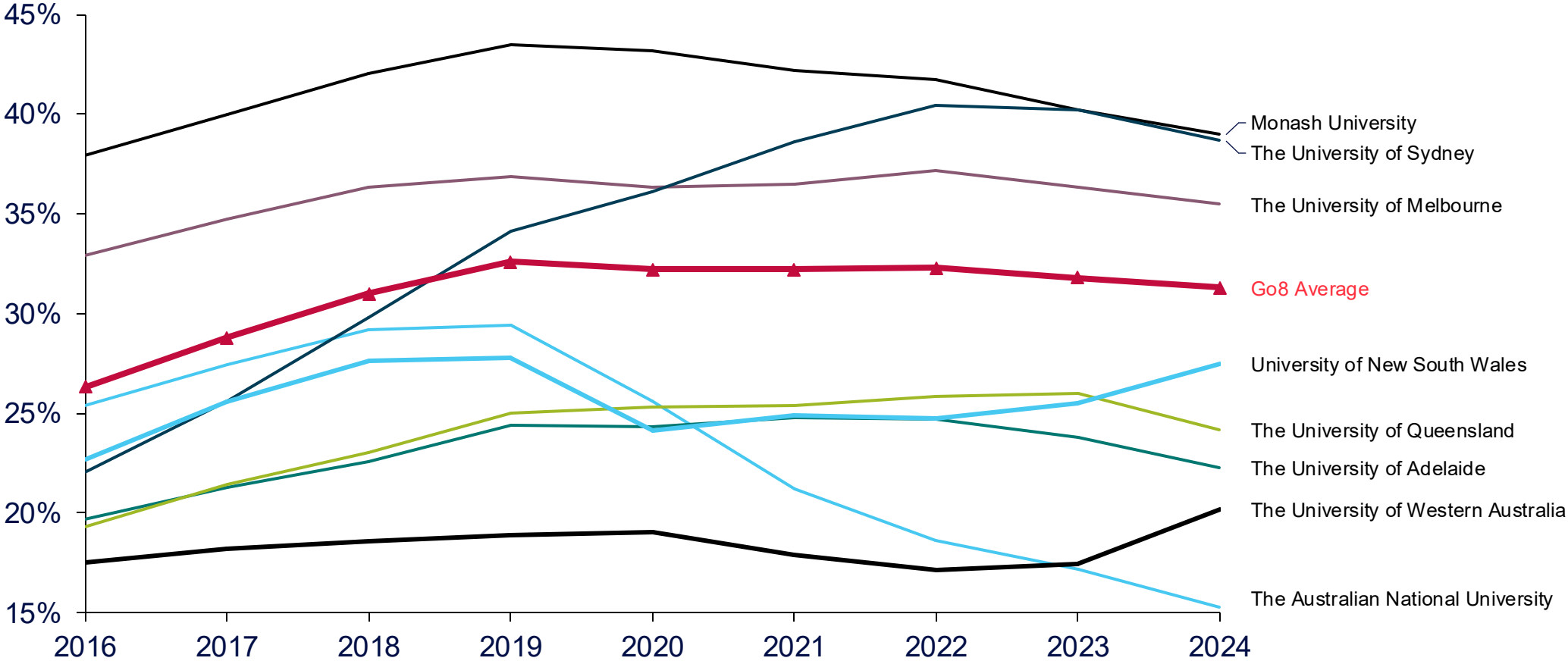
International student %



When looking at full-time Bachelor students only Go8 international split decreasing



International student % (full-time Bachelor students only)



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